

ASSESSMENT RUBRIC - Reading into Writing

Student Name:

Student ID:

Section:

Date:

TASK:

TOTAL SCORE:

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GRADE:

CRITERION	Capstone Proficiency - A Band 5	Developing Proficiency - B Band 4	Baseline Proficiency - D Band 3	Below Baseline - F Band 2	n/a* 1	SCORE
Task Achievement	Paper is a skillfully focused response to the scope of the prompt (question, brief, etc.).	Paper is a sufficiently focused and clearly relevant response to the scope of the prompt.	Paper may be insufficiently focused or not clearly relevant to the scope of the prompt.	Paper is often or usually unfocused and irrelevant to the scope of the prompt.	n/a	
	Comprehensive and detailed coverage of relevant concepts, arguments, and evidence.	Thorough and sufficient coverage of relevant concepts, arguments, and evidence.	Incomplete or superficial coverage. Key concepts, arguments, or evidence insufficiently explained.	Mostly inadequate or simplistic coverage. Key concepts, arguments, or evidence ignored.		
	Locates and synthesizes all relevant source material. Suggests thorough reading.	Locates and synthesizes sufficient relevant source material. Suggests careful reading.	Insufficient source awareness and synthesis. Suggests superficial or partial reading.	Inadequate source awareness and synthesis. Suggests no first-hand reading.		
	Meets all other task requirements (e.g., genre, format(s), structure, preparation, timing, etc.)	Satisfactorily meets task requirements (e.g., one or more minor requirements not met)	Partially meets task requirements (e.g., one major or many minor requirements not met)	Doesn't meet sufficient task requirements (e.g., most requirements not met)		
Citation	Detailed inclusion and accurate representation of source ideas and language.	Sufficient inclusion and plausible representation of source ideas and language.	May oversimplify or misrepresent ideas and language. Some overuse or underuse of source(s).	Frequently misrepresents ideas and language. Overuses or underuses the source(s).	n/a	
	Citations (quotations, paraphrases) are always clearly identified and skillfully integrated.	Citations are almost always or usually clearly identified and integrated.	Citation may not be clearly identified or integrated (e.g., missing attribution or improper punctuation).	Citation often or mostly improperly identified or integrated. Plagiarism or falsification.		
	Referencing (e.g., APA, Chicago, MLA, etc.) is consistent, accurate, and correctly styled.	Referencing almost always or usually consistent, accurate, and correctly styled.	Referencing may be inconsistent, non-functional, or incorrectly styled.	Referencing often or mostly inconsistent, non-functional or incorrectly styled.		
Critical Response	Engagement (interpretations, evaluations) of source(s) is insightful and aware of complexity.	Engagement of source(s) is sufficiently plausible and aware of key interpretive difficulties.	Engagement may be implausible or simplistic. May only describe, rephrase, or review.	Source(s) rarely adequately engaged. Mostly describes, rephrases, or reviews.	n/a	
	Writer's own response (stance/position) is clear, nuanced, and effectively maintained.	Writer's own response is evident, balanced, and consistently maintained.	Writer's own response may be unclear, overly one-sided, or self-inconsistent at times.	Writer's own response is often or usually unclear, limited, biased, or self-contradictory.		
	Reasoning is inventive, well substantiated and supported by persuasive evidence.	Reasoning is plausible, sufficiently developed, and supported by evidence.	Reasoning insufficiently developed; claims, reasons, or evidence may be weak or lacking.	Reasoning inadequate: claims, reasons, or evidence often or usually weak or lacking.		
Language	Writer's voice is present, engaged, and natural; recognizably distinct from source authors.	Writer's voice is personal and natural; identifiably distinct from source authors.	Writer's voice may be generic or unnatural at times; may echo source authors' style or phrasing.	Writer's voice often or usually generic or artificial; patch-written or plagiarized passages.	n/a	
	Style, tone, and register consistent and effective for general academic purposes.	Style, tone, and register mostly consistent and appropriate for general academic purposes.	Style, tone, and register may be inconsistent, and inappropriate at times (e.g., too informal).	Style, tone, and register inconsistent and often inappropriate (e.g., too specialist or too basic).		
	Conceptual terms and topic-related vocabulary used precisely and meaningfully.	Terms and topic-related vocabulary usually used accurately and relevantly.	Terms and vocabulary may be used imprecisely or irrelevantly. Some lexical circumvention.	Terms and vocabulary often misused or irrelevant. Frequent lexical circumvention.		
	Syntax and phrasing are clear, concise, and effective; largely free of errors.	Syntax and phrasing sufficiently clear, concise and varied; no errors that impede meaning.	Syntax and phrasing may be unclear or repetitive due to limited range or errors that impede meaning.	Syntax and phrasing often fail to communicate meaning due to limited range and/or errors.		
Readability	Paper is consistently audience-aware, clear, concise, and coherent.	Paper is generally sufficiently audience-aware, clear, concise, and coherent.	Paper may be unclear, redundant, repetitive, or disjointed at times.	Paper is often or usually vague, redundant, repetitive, or incoherent.	n/a	
	Framing and signaling (openings, previews, shifts of focus, closures) are highly effective.	Framing and signaling are sufficient, functional, and varied.	Framing and signaling may be insufficient or ineffective or feel overly mechanical.	Framing and signaling are mostly or usually absent or ineffective.		
	Flow of points is smoothly ordered and logical. Ideas seem to progress naturally.	Flow of points is clearly ordered and understandable. Ideas are clearly connected.	Flow of points may be unclear. Some ideas may feel misplaced or disconnected.	Flow of points disordered and chaotic. Ideas often seem irrelevant or disjointed.		

See the next page for feedback comments and a glossary of terms used in the rubric.

* not applicable, not appropriate, not acceptable, not attempted, etc.

Feedback Comments

Glossary of Terms

academic - writing for university contexts that participates in scholarly discussion, e.g., by presenting claims, evidence, and sources in an appropriate academic and formal style.

analysis - examination of a text, idea, or issue by identifying its parts and considering and explaining their function, significance, and interrelation.

citation - adaptation or incorporation of ideas, information, or language from a source into one's own writing, e.g., through quotation, paraphrase, or summary.

circumvention - expressing an idea indirectly when a specific word or expression is unknown, e.g., "the things used to show when someone is speaking" for quotation marks.

coherence - logical connection and development of ideas, making a text easy to follow, e.g., through transitions (*however, therefore*) and references (*these ideas, this argument*).

concision - expressing ideas clearly and efficiently, without unnecessary words or redundancy, e.g., *because* rather than *due to the fact that*, or *repeat* rather than *repeat again*.

coverage - the extent to which a response addresses the relevant concepts, arguments, evidence, or issues implied by a task, e.g., discussing all key aspects of a topic rather than only part of it.

critical - involving careful questioning, examination, and judgment based on evidence and reasoning, e.g., *This argument assumes that...* or *The evidence does not fully support...*

evaluation - reasoned judgment of the quality, credibility, strength, or effectiveness of a claim, argument, or source, e.g., *This evidence is persuasive because...*

format - the required way a task is presented, completed, or submitted, e.g., document layout, file type, citation style, word limit, or in-class or take-home completion.

framing - helping readers understand the purpose, focus, and organization of a discussion, e.g., through openings, previews, topic sentences, headings, or conclusions.

genre - a recognizable type of communication with a particular purpose, audience, and set of expectations, e.g., an analytical response, essay, report, reflection, or forum post, etc.

interpretation - explanation of a text's meaning based on evidence from the text, e.g., *The author seems to suggest that...* or *This passage implies that...*

inventive - generating relevant and insightful reasons, examples, implications, comparisons, or applications to support an argument, e.g., a contemporary case or unexpected example.

lexical - relating to vocabulary, word choice, and precision of meaning, e.g., the differences in formality and specificity between *guy, person, individual, stakeholder, participant*, etc.

preparation - the activities required to complete a task, e.g., reading sources, taking notes, outlining ideas, preparing drafts, or using specified technologies before or during the writing process.

phrasing - the different wording used to express an idea, e.g., *This claim may be mistaken because ...* versus *This claim is open to question because ...*

proficiency - overall ability to perform a skill effectively and appropriately, developing from basic (i.e., entry-level or "baseline") to advanced (i.e., exit-level or "capstone") competence.

referencing - documenting and acknowledging the location of source material using a recognized citation style, e.g., APA, MLA, Chicago, or IEEE, etc.

reasoning - explaining why a claim should be accepted by providing reasons, evidence, examples, implications, comparisons, or other forms of support.

register - appropriateness of language choices for a particular audience, purpose, and context, e.g., academic vs. informal language.

response - a personal but reasoned reaction to a text, issue, or argument, supported by evidence or explanation.

reviewing - praising or dismissing source ideas without explanation or support, e.g., simply claiming an idea is *important, inspiring, flawed, or problematic* but not stating *why*.

signaling - indicating relationships, transitions, or shifts in focus between ideas, e.g., through metadiscourse such as *however, in contrast, returning to...*, *this argument suggests...*, etc.

superficial - remaining at the surface level of a topic, e.g., describing or summarizing ideas without sufficiently explaining, analyzing, evaluating, or developing them.

synthesis - bringing together and connecting ideas, information, or evidence from one or more sources, e.g., by identifying relationships, contrasts, patterns, or implications.

stance - perspective, claim, or viewpoint adopted by a writer, signaled by, e.g., emphasis (*It is this optimistic idea that...*), modality (*We must reconsider...*), or phrases (*I will argue that...*).

structure - organization of a text, including by paragraphing to separate and order ideas or by including genre elements such as introduction, discussion, and conclusion sections, etc.

syntax - arrangements of words and phrases to form grammatical sentences, e.g., *Although the evidence is limited, the claim is plausible.* vs. *The claim is plausible despite the limited evidence.*

tone - attitude conveyed through language choices, e.g., academic writing often aims to sound objective, cautious, and reasonable rather than subjective, emotional, or confrontational.

voice - the writer's identifiable presence, perspective, and/or distinctive manner of expression in a text, as distinguishable from the voices of the sources cited and discussed.